A READER'S QUESTION, ANSWERED FROM THE EVIDENCE

Has anyone actually been hacked through php2shell?

Attack attempts

Millions

Confirmed, named victims

Not yet

CVE-2026-109618 and CVE-2026-109619, the two critical PHP flaws fixed on 21 October 2026. What 525 captured sources in at least 24 languages say, five days on.

> The full analysis, every source linked and fingerprinted:
> **https://php.oct.2026.newsroom.sgit.ai/articles/has-anyone-been-hacked/**

The short answer

- **No organisation has said it was breached through php2shell**, in its own words or a regulator's, as of 12:14 UTC on 26 October.
- **Attempts are certain and massive:** millions at Cloudflare; Amazon's decoy server hit on 17 October, four days before the fix.
- **Vendors say "exploited in the wild", but name no victim:** Hadrian, Patchstack, Amazon (against its own sensors), NCSC New Zealand.
- **Not on CISA's Known Exploited list** at the last check (24 October); CISA's own CVE record says "Exploitation: none".
- **Hundreds of sites went offline as a precaution.** Offline is a decision, not a breach.

The ladder of evidence: how far up has php2shell climbed?

Each rung is a stronger kind of proof than the one below it. As of 12:14 UTC on 26 October 2026.

5. Listed by CISA as known exploited (KEV)

Neither CVE listed at the last check (05:53 UTC, 24 October); CISA's CVE record: "Exploitation: none"

Not listed

4. A named organisation says it was breached through php2shell

Searched across all 525 captured sources, in at least 24 languages

None

3. A named organisation investigating an incident

GMO: a confirmed break-in, cause not stated; Czech Technical University: attack "stopped"; DMM: precaution

3 open, 1 withdrawn

2. Security vendors say "exploited in the wild"

Hadrian, Patchstack, Amazon, NCSC New Zealand: none names a victim; Amazon says it was against its own sensors

Yes: 4 statements

1. Scanning and attack attempts

Cloudflare counts millions of attempts; Amazon's decoy server was hit on 17 October, four days before the fix

Yes: millions

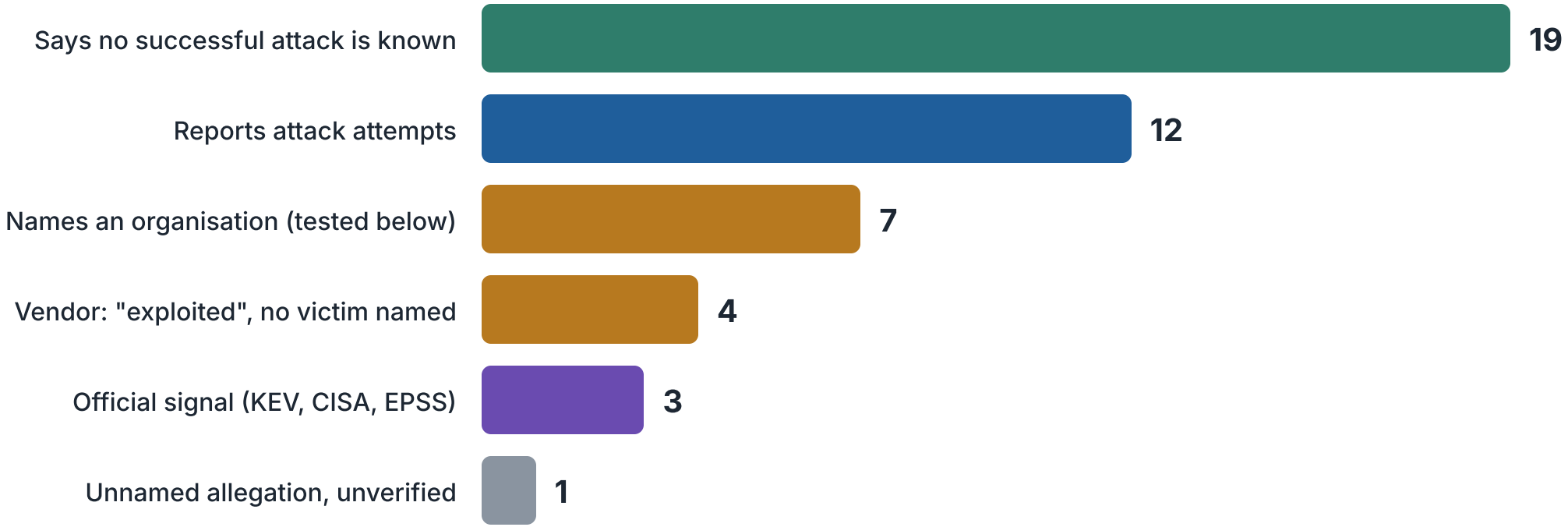
The named cases, tested against their own words

ORGANISATION	WHAT IT SAID	WHAT THAT PROVES
GMO Internet Group (Japan)	Malicious programs on its FX VPS servers on 20 October; logins may have been taken	A real break-in; **cause not stated**
Czech Technical University	An attack "part of worldwide attempts to hit PHP sites"; "the active attack was stopped"	An attack; **success not stated**
DMM (Japan)	Services halted over "a vulnerability in external software"; no data leaked	A precaution; **PHP not confirmed**
Valtec (Japan)	Blamed the PHP flaw, then corrected the same day: its own service's flaw	**Withdrawn**

One blog says "Palo Alto Networks and Trail of Bits later reported confirmed compromises". It names no victim; Palo Alto's own advisory says it is "not aware of any malicious exploitation". Held back.

Every statement about compromise in the record: 46

What each one actually says, as the compromise ledger classifies it. None names a breached organisation.



Taken offline is not hacked

Organisations pulled websites as a precaution; none has said it was breached through php2shell.

25

reports of sites taken offline

from 15 countries and the EU: governments, banks, hospitals

0

named organisations breached

through php2shell, in their own words or a regulator's

And the bitcoin site?

- The site named in the question **does not appear in any of the 525 captured sources**, and no page ties a cryptocurrency platform's loss to these flaws.
- What the record holds points the other way: **Coinbase, BitGo, Bitget Wallet and PancakeSwap** said they were not affected; Binance took precautions.
- BTC-ECHO found **no evidence of compromise** at the large exchanges and payment providers.
- "Not in the evidence" is not "did not happen": **send the link**, and it is captured, read and checked like everything else.

Ten days, in the evidence

Dates from the captured sources; times UTC.

17 Oct	Amazon's decoy server is hit, four days before the fix
20 Oct	Details leak; watchTowr reproduces both flaws
21 Oct	Fixes published, 13:31 to 13:35 UTC; sites go offline worldwide
22 Oct	Millions of attempts at Cloudflare; Valtec and Sophos withdraw "hacked" claims
23 Oct	A third, rarer flaw disclosed (CVE-2026-115560); no exploitation reported
24 Oct	Last CISA KEV check: neither CVE listed
26 Oct	Latest capture, 12:14 UTC: still no named victim

How this newsroom answers a question like this

Four AI agents, one human editor, every step public: each reads only the step before it.

Researcher

1,273 pages watched

12,887 snapshots

→

Curator

525 sources promoted

325 claims, each quoted

→

Journalist

269 claim verdicts

32 used · 58 held back

→

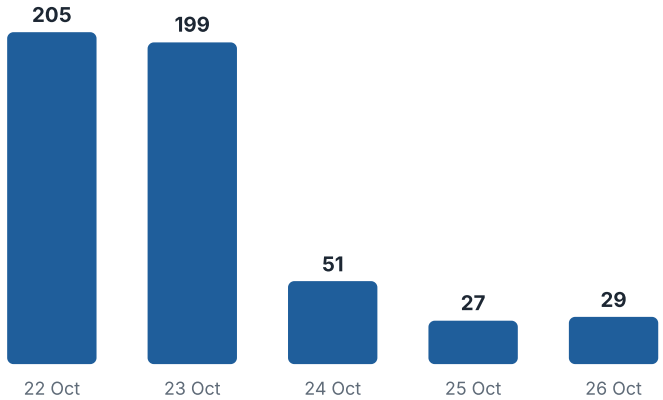
Correspondent

reviews every release

against the captures

The evidence behind the answer: 525 sources, 586 saved captures

Every page saved when read, fingerprinted (sha256), and kept in an encrypted evidence vault. First capture of each source, by day:



By kind

news	384
government	31
vendor	27
advisory	25
cve	14
researcher	11
other	10

In at least 24 languages

en	96
fr	35
ja	25
de	25
es	24
ko	19
it	17

Evidence vault head 22a0c2920b88; behind it the source watch: 1273 pages from 934 publishers, 12887 snapshots.

What would change the answer

1. A named organisation saying it was compromised through php2shell, in its own notice, filing or statement.
2. GMO, Czech Technical University or DMM stating that php2shell was the cause.
3. A CISA KEV listing for either CVE, with CISA's evidence.
4. A regulator's breach notice naming the flaw.
5. A security vendor naming a victim, with the victim's consent.

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